



Sunday School Department • Proclaiming God's Word World Wide

SUNDAY SCHOOL MANUAL

EXCUSE

Memory Verse: Joshua 1:7

Bible Passage: Genesis 3:1–21

Sunday, 18th May 2026



INTRODUCTION

To give an excuse means to provide a reason or explanation for why something was done, not done, or done wrongly. In the phrase, to give an excuse often has a deeper meaning of refusing responsibility, rejecting God's call or attempt to give reasons for our inadequacies in fulfilling or obeying God's words.

Many Christians seek excuses for their failure or inefficiencies in their obligations, duties, or responsibilities in their service to God or fellow men. There are many instances in the Bible that show us that God does not take excuses from people who gave excuses in the Bible.

EXAMPLES OF PEOPLE WHO GAVE EXCUSES

(1) ADAM

(Gen. 3:12; 1 Tim. 2:14)

Adam gave an excuse to exonerate himself for disobeying God's word. He tried to give a good reason by saying God gave the woman who misled him to him as wife.

(2) THE TRIBE OF JOSEPH

(Joshua 17:15–18)

The children of Joseph wanted to give an excuse of the strength and weapons of war possessed by the Canaanites as reason why they would not be able to possess the possessions God had given to them.

(3) MOSES

(Exodus 4:10–14)

Moses tried to use the predicament of speechmaking he had as an excuse, but God refused his excuse.

(4) SAUL

(1 Sam. 15:15, 20–21)

Saul tried to give a good reason (excuse) why he had not obeyed the commandment fully, which was not acceptable to Samuel.

REASONS WHY WE GIVE EXCUSES

(1) Proverbs 3:5 — When we rely on our own understanding rather than trusting God.



(2) **Deuteronomy 4:6** — When you depend on your own wisdom instead of God's wisdom, you are bound to give excuses.

(3) **Philippians 4:13** — When you depend on your own power instead of God's power.

(4) **1 Samuel 13:11–12** — When we allow fear.

(5) **Isaiah 43:18** — When you continue to dwell in the past, you are bound to give excuses.

CONSEQUENCES OF GIVING EXCUSES

(1) **Anger of the Lord** (*1 Sam. 15:10–11*)

(2) **Destruction**

(3) **Failed Promises** — Judah and Benjamin (*Judges 1:19b, 21*)

(4) **Replacement** — God replaced Saul with David. (*1 Sam. 13:14*)

(5) **Curse** (*Gen. 3:17–19*)

CONCLUSION

The Bible says we can do all things through Christ who strengthens us. If we rely and trust in Him, we will not find reasons to give excuses. As believers, let us believe we can do and achieve all things through Christ who strengthens us.

Memory Verse: *"Only be thou strong and very courageous, that thou mayest observe to do according to all the law, which Moses my servant commanded thee."*

— **Joshua 1:7 (KJV)**